

County Administration Workshop: June 16, 2026

1:30 p.m. – Board of Commissioners Conference Room

Attending: Commissioners Ron A. Smith; Colene M. Martin; Gary L. Richardson; and Nikole Guzman, Recorder

Chair Ron Smith called the meeting to order at 1:30 p.m.

1. Declaration of Potential Conflicts of Interest

The board declared there are no potential conflicts of interest.

2. Department Business

a. Juvenile Justice

1. Provider Agreement with Restorative Solutions in the amount of \$20,000.00

Scott Hyde, Community Justice Director, presented a renewal agreement with Restorative Solutions for restorative justice training services. Hyde explained that restorative justice focuses on repairing harm caused by criminal behavior through communication, accountability, and relationship restoration. The training supports Community Justice staff and reinforces the department's restorative justice model, particularly within juvenile programs. Hyde noted the agreement is an annual renewal, not to exceed \$20,000, and was included within the approved budget.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve Contract with Restorative Solutions in the amount of \$20,000.00. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call; Commissioner Richardson – yes, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – yes. Motion carried 3-0.

2. Resolution No. 2026-024; In the Matter of the Josephine County Board of Commissioners Affirming Tobacco Retail Enforcement as Way to Protect Legal Consumer Access and Support a Regulated Market Place

Eckhardt-Doupen Martinez, Prevention, presented a revised resolution regarding tobacco retail enforcement. Martinez explained that Community Justice receives state funding to conduct tobacco retailer inspections, compliance checks, and youth access enforcement activities. He clarified that the resolution did not originate from Community Justice but was revised at the Board's request to recognize both adult consumer choice and the protection of lawful businesses while maintaining support for youth tobacco prevention efforts. Commissioners discussed the prior resolution approved by the Board and acknowledged the need to formally correct the process through a properly noticed agenda item. Discussion occurred regarding balancing adult consumer choice with efforts to prevent youth access to tobacco and nicotine products. Commissioners also discussed correspondence received from public health advocacy organizations and the importance of distinguishing adult consumer rights from youth prevention strategies.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve Rescind Resolution No. 2026-009 and Approve Resolution No. 2026-027; In the Matter of the Josephine County Board of Commissioners Affirming Tobacco Retail Enforcement as Way to Protect Legal Consumer Access and Support a Regulated Market Place. Commissioner Smith seconded the motion. Upon roll call; Commissioner Richardson – yes, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – yes. Motion carried 3-0.

b. Public Works

1. Access Josephine County Property to Devils Slide

Richard Pike, Public Works Manager, and Helene Lulich, Property Manager, presented a request from Rural Metro Fire and the Oregon Department of Forestry for access across County-owned property near Devil's Slide. Meyer explained that emergency responders have experienced difficulties accessing the area during fire suppression and emergency response incidents and that the proposed project would create a gravel access route sufficient for fire apparatus and emergency vehicles. Meyer noted that the project would be completed and maintained by the requesting agencies with no anticipated financial impact to Josephine County. Commissioners discussed emergency access needs, wildfire response, maintenance responsibilities, property rights, and liability considerations. Commissioner Richardson expressed concern regarding long-term access rights and recommended a more formal agreement rather than informal email authorization. Legal Counsel advised that an access agreement would provide appropriate protections without creating a permanent easement. Commissioners agreed that emergency access improvements were beneficial and directed staff to proceed with temporary authorization while preparing a more formal agreement for future consideration.

c. Forestry

1. Timber Sale Contract Pumpchance 2026TS-1

Brian Bradac, Forester II, presented three timber sale contracts for Board consideration. Commissioners discussed the proposed sales and noted the continued importance of timber revenue generated from County forest lands.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve Timber Sale Contract Pumpchance 2026TS-1. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call; Commissioner Richardson – yes, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – yes. Motion carried 3-0.

2. Timber Sale Contract Butte 2026TS-2

Commissioner Martin moved to approve Timber Sale Contract Butte 2026TS-2. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call; Commissioner Richardson – yes, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – yes. Motion carried 3-0.

3. Timber Sale Contract Winona-Orofino 2026TS-3

Commissioner Martin moved to approve Timber Sale Contract Winona-Orofino 2026TS-3. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call; Commissioner Richardson – yes, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – yes. Motion carried 3-0.

d. Human Resources

1. Position Requisitions

- a. Community Corrections – Work Crew Coordinator – Add Position - Fill-in only
- b. Community Corrections – Treatment Counselor – Replace Existing Classification
- c. District Attorney – Chief Deputy District Attorney – Changing Current Position Description
- d. District Attorney – Deputy District Attorney III – Changing Current Position Description
- e. District Attorney – Deputy District Attorney II – Changing Current Position Description
- f. District Attorney – Deputy District Attorney I – Changing Current Position Description
- g. Fairgrounds – Temporary Fair Aide (8) – Add Temporary Positions (8)

2. Personnel Actions

- a. District Attorney – Deputy District Attorney I – Reclass Up
- b. District Attorney – Deputy District Attorney II – Reclass Up
- c. District Attorney – Deputy District Attorney III – Reclass Up
- d. District Attorney – Deputy District Attorney III – Reclass Up
- e. District Attorney – Deputy District Attorney III – Reclass Up
- f. District Attorney – Chief Deputy District Attorney – Reclass Up
- g. Juvenile Justice – Group Life Counselor II fill in – New Hire – Approved 1/3/2024
- h. Public Works – Public Works Director - Reinstatement
- i. Sheriff's Department –
- j. Police Support Technician –
- k. Transit full time
- l. Transits part time

Natalie Eckhardt-Doupe, Human Resources Analyst, presented several personnel requests for Board consideration.

Community Corrections Work Crew Coordinator (On-Call)

Eckhardt-Doupe presented a request to recruit and hire an on-call Work Crew Coordinator to provide staffing coverage during employee absences and leave periods. The position was included within the approved budget and would be utilized as needed to maintain program operations. No objections were raised.

Community Corrections Treatment Counselor Case Management Training Coordinator

Eckhardt-Doupe and Community Justice Director Scott Hyde presented a request to create a Treatment Counselor Case Management Training Coordinator position by modifying an existing classification. Hyde explained that the position would recognize expanded responsibilities currently being performed by an employee who provides training, curriculum instruction, assessments, and statewide case management support in addition to counseling duties. Commissioners expressed support for the reclassification.

District Attorney Position Reclassifications

Eckhardt-Doupe presented revisions to the Chief Deputy District Attorney and Deputy District Attorney I, II, and III position descriptions to reflect compensation adjustments approved during the budget process. Discussion occurred regarding

recruitment, retention, and maintaining competitive salaries within the District Attorney's Office. Commissioners noted the importance of attracting and retaining qualified attorneys and expressed support for the proposed changes. The salary adjustments will become effective July 1, 2026.

Fairgrounds Temporary Fair Aides

Eckhardt-Doupe presented a request to recruit temporary Fair Aide positions to assist with preparation and operations associated with the 2026 Josephine County Fair. Commissioners acknowledged that similar positions are utilized annually and raised no concerns.

Public Works Director Reinstatement

Eckhardt-Doupe presented personnel actions associated with reinstating the Public Works Director position. Discussion occurred regarding departmental organization and staffing needs. No objections were raised.

Sheriff's Office Personnel Actions

Eckhardt-Doupe presented personnel actions involving the hiring of a Deputy Corrections Officer, recruitment of a Police Support Technician, and the transfer of two Deputy Corrections Officers into patrol deputy positions. Discussion occurred regarding recruitment efforts and staffing needs within the Sheriff's Office.

Transit Personnel Actions

Eckhardt-Doupe presented personnel actions associated with transit service adjustments, including the reduction of a full-time and a part-time position to on-call status due to route changes and operational needs. Discussion occurred regarding seniority rights and collective bargaining agreement provisions.

3. BOARD BUSINESS**a. Oregon Groundwater Association Presentation**

Kevin Gill, representing the Oregon Groundwater Association, provided an overview of pending Oregon Water Resources Department rulemaking related to groundwater regulation, exempt wells, enforcement procedures, and water distribution. Gill explained that many Josephine County residents rely upon private wells and emphasized the importance of local participation in the rulemaking process. He encouraged the Board to submit comments before the June 26, 2026 deadline and offered to provide supporting materials and suggested comment language.

Commissioners discussed water rights, groundwater management, exempt well regulation, and proposed state-level policy changes. Concerns were expressed regarding potential future requirements affecting private well owners and agricultural water users. The Board directed staff to place the matter on a future agenda for further discussion and public awareness.

b. Resolution No. 2026-028; In the Matter of Consenting to the Change in Assignment of Southern Oregon Sanitation, Inc.

Wally Hicks, Counsel, presented Resolution No. 2026-028 regarding the proposed assignment and transfer of Southern Oregon Sanitation, Inc. franchise interests. Hicks explained that the resolution was substantially consistent with actions being considered by other affected jurisdictions and would also be presented during the upcoming Weekly Business Session to allow for public comment prior to any Board action.

Representative Trent Carpenter of Southern Oregon Sanitation and Waste Connections discussed the pending ownership transfer and reviewed the regulatory process governing solid waste franchises. Discussion focused on franchise oversight, rate-setting authority, annual financial reviews, and the role of the Southern Oregon Solid Waste Agency. Commissioners expressed interest in ensuring that the public understood that any future rate increases would remain subject to existing review and approval processes and that the proposed transaction represented an ownership change rather than a modification of service levels or franchise obligations.

No action was taken. The matter was scheduled for consideration during the Weekly Business Session.

4. OTHER**5. ADDITIONAL SUBJECT MATTERS FROM COMMISSIONERS/ANNOUNCEMENTS:**

Commissioner

The meeting adjourned at 2:19 p.m.